Notes

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1 Exceptions to this are typically reasoned in discourses that highlight the workings of gender, ethnicity and class in situating particular women as anomalies to the rule, and as such confirm rather than subvert the exclusion of women from public dialogues and processes. These inscribe women with masculine characteristics: for example, Olive Yang, whose command over ethnic Kokang rebel forces in the 1950s was understood to have been made possible precisely because of her 'male' attributes, or discourses that emphasize women's royal and/or political male connections, for example, Aung San Suu Kyi and Nang Hern Kham (one of the founders of the Shan State Army) (Ferguson 2013).

2 This chapter draws on select publications, including Hedström (2015a).

3 For more information about the research process, see Hedström (2015a).

4 Marital rape is only criminalized if the wife is younger than fourteen. See Gender Equality Network (2013).

5 Article 445 of the 2008 Constitution of Myanmar states that, "No proceeding shall be instituted against the said [previously ruling] Councils or any member thereof or any member of the Government, in respect of any act done in the execution of their respective duties." Article 381 states that "[e]xcept in the following situations and time, no citizen shall be denied redress by due process of law for grievances entitled under law: (a) in time of foreign invasion; (b) in time of insurrection; (c) in time of emergency." Article 382 states that "[i]n order to carry out their duties fully and to maintain the discipline by the Defence Forces personnel or members of the armed forces responsible [for ensuring] peace and security, the rights given in this Chapter [Citizen, Fundamental Rights and Duties of the Citizens] shall be restricted or revoked through enactment [of] law".

6 Similarly, a report published in 2014 highlights how female soldiers felt that civilian women do not have security in Kachin State. These soldiers then went on to discuss the importance of the KIA, and the bearing of arms to defend oneself and one's community (Centre for Peace and Conflict Studies 2014).

7 Corporal, KIA, Kachin State, Myanmar, 12 October 2013. All quotes are translated from Burmese unless otherwise indicated and have been transcribed verbatim.

8 The 2015 Census was not carried out in KIO-controlled areas of Kachin State, therefore the results are estimates.

9 Soldier, KIA, Kachin State, Myanmar, 11 October 2013.

10 This holds true also for the Tatmadaw where women were until recently banned